Printavo Shipper — Staff Guide

Turning a completed Printavo order into a printed UPS or FedEx label

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1. First-time setup

Printavo Shipper is a single `Printavo Shipper.exe` file — no installer, and nothing else to install on a Windows 11 PC. Its settings live on that PC under the Windows user who runs it, so set it up while signed in as the account staff will use. Everything below is on the `Settings` screen; click `Save Settings` at the bottom when you're done.

> **Bring your own UPS and FedEx API keys.** The app doesn't come with any carrier credentials. Before setup, sign up for your own free developer account at the **UPS Developer Portal** (developer.ups.com) — and the **FedEx Developer Portal** (developer.fedex.com) if you ship FedEx — create an app/project there to get a Client ID and Client Secret, and link your shipping account number to it. New keys start in the carrier's test environment; switching to live shipping may require extra approval steps with the carrier.

> **FedEx label certification: use a laser printer.** To get your FedEx developer project approved for live shipping, FedEx has you print sample labels, scan them, and submit the scans. This app produces FedEx labels as PDF images, and FedEx only accepts thermal-printed labels in ZPL or EPL format — so print the certification labels on a **laser printer**, not a thermal one. Set `Settings` → Label Printer → *Label paper* to `Letter8x11Centered` and choose the laser printer while you print them.

Connections

Card	What to enter
Printavo	Your Printavo login email and API token (from your Printavo account settings). Click `Test Printavo Connection` — it shows who you're signed in as.

UPS	The Client ID and Client Secret from your app on the UPS Developer Portal. Leave `Environment` on `Cie` (UPS's test system — labels aren't real and cost nothing) until you're ready, then switch to `Production`. Click `Test UPS Connection`.
Our UPS Accounts	Add at least one of your own UPS account numbers (with its zip). Mark one as Default. If you add several, `Get Rates` compares them all.
FedEx (optional)	Only needed if you ship FedEx. The Client ID and Client Secret from your FedEx Developer Portal project, the account number tied to that project, and the environment (`Sandbox` for testing, then `Production`). Click `Test FedEx Connection`.
Our FedEx Accounts	If you ship FedEx, add at least one of your own FedEx account numbers.

> **Your own carrier account is always required.** UPS and FedEx both need one of your own accounts as the shipper — even when a customer's third-party account pays for the shipment. Until one is added, shipment cards show a yellow warning and the Ship button stays disabled.

Your shop

Card	What to enter
Printavo Workflow	Loads your Printavo account's own statuses and users (click `Reload from Printavo` if you change them in Printavo). • **Order statuses** — tick *Shipping* for the statuses staff should be able to set on shipped orders, *Pick-up* for pick-up orders, and *Hide* for statuses that should never appear in the Orders list (quotes, already shipped, on hold…). • **Delivery methods** — your Printavo delivery method names, comma-separated, for each of UPS, FedEx, and Pick-up. An order whose delivery method isn't listed ships via UPS with a warning. • **Staff** — tick the people who should appear in the order screen's *Add Task* list and the UPS *also notify on delivery* list. Their email starts as their Printavo login; change it if they read a different inbox, or clear it to leave them out of notifications. • **Shipping-cost tasks assigned to** — who gets the Printavo task recording the cost of shipments billed to your own account: a fixed person, the order's owner, or nobody.
Default Ship-From Address	Your shop's name, address, and phone. Direct customers' orders ship from here, and all rates are quoted from here.
Shipping Defaults	Your standard box sizes (the first one is the starting size for each new package), and the markup added to your negotiated rate when charging shipping on an invoice (Section 2).
Label Printer	The Windows printer for labels, and the paper: 4x6 label stock on a label printer, or plain 8.5x11 paper on an office printer. Click `Print Test Label`. Also choose the logo printed on pick-up box labels (Section 5).
Shipment History	How often old, finished shipments are exported to a backup file and cleared out of History.

> **Label formats and printers.** UPS sends labels as GIF images and FedEx as 4x6 PDFs; the app keeps a copy of each for reprints. Labels print through the normal Windows printer driver as an image — at 4x6 on a label printer, or at true size centered on a letter sheet. The app does **not** produce ZPL or EPL printer code, so your printer needs a Windows driver (most thermal label printers have one); a printer that only accepts raw ZPL/EPL commands won't work.

2. Shipping an order

1. Click `Orders` in the left nav. Either type the order number into `Order #` and press Enter, or use `Search` to browse/filter, then click `Open` next to the right order.
2. The order screen shows the **Production Note** and **Customer Note** straight from Printavo — always read these before shipping, they carry any special instructions for that order.
3. Under **Ship-To Address**, click `Ship this address` next to the address you're shipping to. This opens a shipment card below. The order's Printavo delivery method decides whether it's a UPS or a FedEx card.
4. On the shipment card, check/set:
   - **Ship From** — who the package is shipping from (see Section 3).
   - **Our UPS/FedEx Account** and **Service Level** — which of your own accounts the label goes out under, and the service (Ground, etc.).
   - **Bill To** — leave unchecked to bill your own account, or check "*Bill third-party … account*" if this customer pays for their own shipping. Cards start on third-party billing only when the contractor has a saved billing account for that carrier.
   - **Packages** — pick a box size preset or type in your own weight/dimensions. Use `Clone` to duplicate a row for identical boxes, or `+ Add Package` for a new one.
   - **Notes** (optional) — e.g. *DESIGN 1 & DESIGN 2*; shown after the tracking number in the customer note.
5. Click `Get Rates` to see costs — click any quote to apply that service level/account to the card (the applied quote stays highlighted). **This is required when billing your own account**: the quoted cost is what gets recorded in Shipment History and the Printavo task. If you change anything afterward (boxes, weights, dimensions, the address, or billing), click `Get Rates` again. It's optional for third-party billing.
6. Click `Ship & Print Label` (or press `Ctrl+Enter` while the shipment card has focus). This purchases the real label, prints it (or saves it if no printer is selected — see Section 11), and updates the Printavo order automatically (see the green result panel).

> If `Ship & Print Label` is grayed out, the app tells you why right under the button (e.g. no rates fetched yet, or a package without a weight) — fix whatever it names and the button re-enables.

> **Charging the customer for shipping (UPS).** When billing your own UPS account, check "*Add Shipping Cost To Invoice*" to add a **Shipping** line (not taxable) to the order's Printavo invoice when the label is created. Pick which rate to charge:
>
> - **Negotiated Rate**: your negotiated UPS cost plus the markup set in *Settings → Shipping Defaults*.
> - **Published Rate**: UPS's published (list) rate. If that's no higher than your negotiated cost, it charges negotiated + markup instead.
>
> The exact amount shows under the options once you click `Get Rates`. Voiding the shipment removes the Shipping line from the invoice again. The option is hidden for third-party billing, since that customer already pays UPS directly.

> **Costs are always as if shipped from your shop.** Rates are quoted from the Default Ship-From Address in Settings, even when the label's return address is a contractor's — the boxes physically leave your shop, so that's the cost tracked.

> **Reference numbers and the customer note are automatic.** The order's PO # and invoice # are sent to the carrier as reference numbers on the label with no extra steps, and a bullet like "*UPS GROUND: 1Z…*" is added to the top of the Printavo customer note the moment the label is created — no need to type tracking numbers into Printavo by hand. Shipments billed to your own account also add a Printavo task recording the cost.

Updating the order's Printavo status

The **Printavo** panel on the right of the order screen has a **Status** picker with the statuses chosen in Settings. Pick one and click `Update`. The same panel has **Add Task** for leaving a Printavo task on the order for one of your staff (e.g. an overage or shortage).

If the address won't validate

A status line under the ship-to address shows whether the carrier recognizes it. If it says it couldn't verify the address, double-check it's correct before shipping — you can still ship either way. If Printavo's address on file is flat-out wrong (missing street, wrong city, etc.), click `Edit Address` next to the ship-to summary to correct it for this shipment. This only affects the shipment you're creating — it does not change the order in Printavo.

3. Direct customers vs. Contractors

Every order belongs to a Printavo customer, but the app treats them one of two ways:

Type	What it means	Ships from
Direct customer (default)	Nothing has been set up for this customer — most walk-in/one-off customers.	Your shop's Default Ship-From Address automatically.
Contractor	A reseller/business account someone has explicitly imported and configured (see Section 9) — e.g. another shop you produce for.	That contractor's own saved ship-from address (and optionally their own UPS/FedEx billing accounts).

> A customer is *never* automatically turned into a Contractor just by opening their order — it only happens through the deliberate "Import from Printavo" step on the Contractors screen. If a Contractor is archived, their orders fall back to shipping as a Direct customer until they're unarchived.

4. Orders with more than one ship-to address

If an order has additional addresses on it (a split-ship order), they appear under **Additional Ship-To Addresses** below the default one — each with its own `Ship this address` button. Click it for each destination to create a separate shipment card (and a separate label) per address.

When an order has multiple ship-to addresses, the customer note lines are automatically labeled so they're easy to tell apart, e.g.:

```
SMITH ST - UPS GROUND: 1Z...
MONTAGUE ST - UPS GROUND: 1Z...
```

5. Pick-up orders: box labels & status

Orders whose delivery method is one of your Pick-up methods (Settings → Printavo Workflow) show up in the `Orders` list like any other order (check the **Delivery** column). They don't get a shipping label, so opening one shows a **Box Labels** card instead of ship-to addresses.

1. Type the number of boxes into `Number of boxes`.
2. Click `Print Box Labels`. One label prints per box, numbered automatically: "*Box 1 of 3*", "*Box 2 of 3*", "*Box 3 of 3*".
3. Set the Printavo **Status** (right side) to one of your pick-up statuses and click `Update`.

> **Whose logo prints?** If the order has a contractor profile in Printavo, the label carries that contractor's logo and phone number, pulled straight from Printavo — the same ones Printavo's own box label uses. Otherwise it carries your shop's logo, set once under `Settings` → Label Printer → *Box label logo*. Shop-branded labels also print the customer's name in large white-on-black letters, so the boxes can be spotted on the pick-up shelf from across the room. The Box Labels card shows which logo it will use before you print.

6. UPS Email Notifications (Quantum View)

Each UPS shipment card has a **UPS Email Notifications** checkbox — off by default. Turning it on reveals:

- **Notify (pickup + delivery)** — the primary email, pre-filled from the order's contact if Printavo has one on file. Gets notified when UPS picks up and when it's delivered.
- **Also notify on delivery only** — an optional dropdown of your staff (Settings → Printavo Workflow → Staff). Pick a name (or leave it on "(none)") to also notify that person only when the package is *delivered*. On the order screen this starts on the order's owner in Printavo, if they're on the staff list; change it or set it to "(none)" per shipment.

7. One-off shipments (New Shipment)

For a package that doesn't come from a Printavo order's address — samples, returns, a replacement part — click `New Shipment` in the left nav. Type the ship-to address, pick **UPS** or **FedEx**, and click `Add Shipment`; the shipment card works exactly like the one on an order.

Optionally link it to a Printavo order by number. A linked shipment records its tracking number and cost as a single Printavo task on that order, instead of a customer-note line.

8. After you ship: reprints, voids, and fixing a failed sync

Every shipment you've created lives on the `History` screen — search by order #, tracking #, or ship-to company name. Each row has:

- **Open Order** — jump straight back to that order.
- **Reprint** — reprints the saved label to the currently selected printer.
- **Void** — cancels the shipment with the carrier (only shown while it's still voidable), and removes its Shipping line from the Printavo invoice if one was added.

- **Retry Sync** — only appears if the Printavo write-back (the cost-tracking task, the customer note, and/or the invoice Shipping line) didn't fully go through after shipping, e.g. because of a brief internet hiccup. Click it to try again.

> Check the **"Needs Printavo sync only"** box on the History screen every so often to sweep for anything that silently failed to sync back to Printavo.

> **Void** and **Remove** (on an unshipped card back on the order screen) both ask you to confirm before doing anything — a safeguard against an accidental click, not a sign something's wrong.

9. Setting up a new Contractor

1. Go to `Contractors` and open the **Import from Printavo** section.
2. Search for the company name and click `Add` next to the right one.
3. Select them in the list. Add at least one **ship-from address** (their own shipping address — mark one as Default). If they pay for their own shipping, add their account under **Third-Party Billing Accounts** (UPS: account number + zip) and/or **FedEx Billing Accounts**.
4. From then on, any of their orders will default to shipping from their address, billed to their account if one is saved.

To temporarily stop treating someone as a contractor (without losing their setup), select them and click `Archive` — their orders fall back to Direct-customer shipping until you `Unarchive` them.

> Deleting a ship-from address or billing account asks you to confirm first. If the one you delete was the contractor's default, another one is automatically promoted to Default.

10. Keyboard shortcuts

The app follows your Windows light/dark setting automatically, and a few shortcuts speed up common moves:

Shortcut	Does what
`Ctrl+1`	Jump to Orders
`Ctrl+2`	Jump to Contractors
`Ctrl+3`	Jump to History
`Ctrl+4`	Jump to Settings
`Ctrl+5`	Jump to New Shipment
`Alt+Left`	Back to the previous screen
`Ctrl+Enter`	Ship & Print Label, while a shipment card has focus

11. Troubleshooting quick reference

You see…	What it means / what to do

"Add your own UPS/FedEx account before shipping."	No account of your own is set up for that carrier. Add one under `Settings` → Our UPS Accounts / Our FedEx Accounts, then reopen the order.
"No shop ship-from address"	Fill in `Settings` → Default Ship-From Address. The carrier rejects labels without one.
"Unrecognized delivery method"	The order's Printavo delivery method isn't in Settings → Printavo Workflow → Delivery methods, so it's defaulting to UPS. Fix the order in Printavo, or add the name in Settings.
The status picker or Add Task list is empty	Nothing is ticked yet under Settings → Printavo Workflow (Order statuses / Staff).
"No printer selected in Settings — labels were saved but not printed."	Go to `Settings` and pick a printer under Label Printer. The shipment still went through and the label is saved — reprint it from History once a printer is set.
"Couldn't validate address" / an address warning	Not necessarily wrong — just unverified. Double-check it looks right, correct it with `Edit Address` if needed, then ship.
"Printavo task not created" / "Customer note not updated"	The label already shipped successfully — this is only about Printavo's own records. Use `Retry Sync` on the History screen.
"This contractor doesn't have a ship-from address or billing accounts set up yet."	Click `Set up this contractor` and fill in at least a ship-from address (Section 9) before shipping their order.
Missing PO # on the label	The order has no PO # entered in Printavo — that reference is left blank, and the invoice # still prints. Add the PO # in Printavo if it should be there.
